

Economy Race

A local Screeps competition module

[docs/competitions/04-economy-race.md](#)

Summary

The learner races an NPC economy bot to hit early growth milestones, focusing on reliable harvesting, source assignment, spawn uptime, and controller progress.

Skill Target

- Primary: economy stability and growth pacing.
- Secondary: source assignment, role counts, construction timing.
- Program track: Builder, Episodes 2-5.
- Recommended episodes: [docs/tutorials/02-target-selection.md](#) through [docs/tutorials/05-construction-and-roads.md](#).

Prerequisites

- Learner has a fresh or reset room.
- ZeSwarm is installed and registered as `zeswarm`.
- Learner can inspect RCL, creep count, and spawn idle time.

Setup

Open the CLI:

```
docker exec -it autonate-screeps screeps-launcher cli
```

Spawn ZeSwarm in a separate unowned room:

```
bots.spawn('zeswarm', 'W3N2', { cpu: 100, gcl: 1 })
```

Challenge

Reach the agreed milestone before the benchmark bot or before a fixed time box expires.

Suggested first milestone:

- Reach RCL 2.
- Maintain at least three useful creeps.
- Build at least one extension.
- Keep spawn idle time low enough that the learner can explain every idle period.

Pressure

The bot acts as a benchmark, not necessarily a direct attacker.

Win Condition

The learner passes when:

- The colony reaches the milestone inside the time box.
- Both sources are used intentionally or the learner can justify not using both.
- Spawn behavior is role-count driven, not hand-spawned.
- The learner compares their progress to the bot or to their previous run.

Scoring

Metric	Full Credit	Partial Credit
Outcome	Reaches milestone and keeps economy running.	Reaches milestone with manual intervention.
Code behavior	Role targets adapt to room state.	Role targets exist but are brittle.
Debugging process	Learner identifies one wasted tick pattern.	Learner only reports final RCL.

Replay

Use a fresh local room or reset the world state, then run the same benchmark again.

Reflection

- Where did energy wait too long?
- Which role blocked progress first?
- What did the bot do earlier than you?

Extensions

- Easier: race only against the clock.
- Harder: require RCL 3 and tower construction.
- Team variant: compare two learner colonies against the same benchmark.